

RECENT DDOS

ATTACKS–NIDAL

1. Cloudflare 11.5 Tbps Attack (September 2025)

- Target: A European network infrastructure company protected by Cloudflare.
- Technology Used: Multi-vector DDoS attack using the Aisuru botnet, combining DNS amplification and Layer 7 HTTP floods.
- Attacker's Motive: Suspected to be linked to hacktivist groups seeking to disrupt European telecom resilience tests.
- Impact: Temporarily slowed transit traffic routes in northern Europe; no complete outages due to Cloudflare mitigation.
- Defensive Strategies: Cloud-based mitigation networks, AI-driven traffic analytics, and strict rate limiting could mitigate future incidents.

2. Cloudflare 7.3 Tbps Attack (May 2025)

- Target: Cloudflare's own infrastructure and major clients, including financial and telecom systems.
- Technology Used: Botnet-powered HTTP/2 floods and SYN amplification attacks spanning multiple vectors.
- Attacker's Motive: Possibly driven by cybercrime-for-hire activities, with ransom demands preceding the event.
- Impact: Represented one of the largest traffic bursts ever recorded—37.4 TB in 45 seconds—but was instantly mitigated.
- Defensive Strategies: Layer 3–7 filtering and automated traffic scrubbing centers remain critical for mitigating volumetric floods.

3. Eastern Asia ISP Attack (October 2024)

- Target: A large Internet Service Provider in Eastern Asia.

- Technology Used: Mirai-variant IoT botnet strain generating 13,000+ sources with a peak of 5.6 Tbps.
- Attacker's Motive: Likely cybercrime aimed at extortion and displaying botnet capabilities for rent.
- Impact: Temporary latency spikes and partial regional outages but no sustained downtime due to rapid mitigation.
- Defensive Strategies: Proactive IoT device monitoring, upstream filtering, and autonomous mitigation systems can prevent such incidents.

4. Anonymous Sudan vs Microsoft (June–July 2023)

- Target: Microsoft services including OneDrive, Azure, and Outlook.
- Technology Used: HTTP(S) flood, cache bypass, and Slowloris techniques.
- Attacker's Motive: Hacktivism tied to anti-Western political campaigns (#FUCK_USA operations).

- Impact: Outages across several Microsoft services for hours, causing user frustration and revenue impact.
- Defensive Strategies: Geo-specific rate limiting, CDN distribution, and behavioral anomaly detection.

5. European Telecom Attack (2025)

- Target: European telecommunications infrastructure.
- Technology Used: Multi-vector attack combining UDP amplification, SYN floods, and HTTP/2 layer 7 payloads.
- Attacker's Motive: Regional destabilization during geopolitical unrest, possibly hacktivist-coordinated.
- Impact: Network slowdowns in multiple countries; some localized communication system failures.
- Defensive Strategies: Zero-trust network segmentation, redundant routing, and large-scale traffic analysis systems